



FAQ List – Camp Conway & Camp Sierpinski

Arrivals

1. What time is arrival?

Answer: Families are asked to arrive between 12:30 - 3:30 pm. We will have a camper and parent lounge available with games and staff meet & greets after checking in.

2. Can parents help students move into the dorm room?

Answer: Yes, parents will be allowed to accompany campers to their room and help them with unpacking. No parents will be allowed in the dormitory after 4:30 pm on arrival day.

3. Will there be parent activities?

Answer: Yes, parents are invited to attend the Opening Ceremony, which will begin at 4:30 pm. Parents and campers will be seated separately and campers will exit before parents, so be sure to say goodbye before going into the ceremony.

4. When do parents depart?

Answer: After the Opening Ceremony, students head to dinner. Parents can stay for a bit to mingle, but we ask that you depart by 6 pm. There will be no chance to meet with your campers after the opening ceremony, so be sure to say goodbye before heading into the ceremony where campers will be seated together.

5. What will the campers do after dinner?

Answer: After dinner, we have an all-camp get to know you activity. Then students break into counselor groups, review rules & tomorrow's schedule, and do a fun activity together. Campers start getting ready for bed at 9:00 pm.

6. Can you recommend a nearby hotel? Is there a discount rate available?

Answer: Yes, hotels are listed below:

**Camp Conway:**

Doubletree Hotel Claremont
555 W Foothill Blvd, Claremont, CA 91711;
(909) 626-2411
Book discounted rate via [THIS LINK](#) (or use
corporate code 560060629)

Camp Sierpinski:

Hyatt House Raleigh Downtown / Seaboard
Station
11 Seaboard Avenue, Raleigh, NC 27604;
(984) 326-7710
Book discounted rate via [THIS LINK](#) (or use
corporate code 14157)

7. What airport should I fly into? Is there a shuttle available?

Answer: We are **not** providing shuttle service to/from the airport at this time.

The closest airport to Camp Conway is ONT to Camp Sierpinski is RDU. These are our recommended airports, however there are a few additional options listed below for Camp Conway.

Camp	Airport	Distance	Estimated Rideshare Costs*
Conway	ONT	10 miles	~25-35
Conway	SNA	35 miles	~\$80-100
Conway	LAX	50 miles	~\$150-250**
Sierpinski	RDU	13 miles	~\$25-35

*Please note that rideshare costs can vary depending on time of day and demand.

**Another option if you're flying into LAX is to use the San Bernardino Metrolink train. It runs between the Los Angeles Union Station (which is available via bus from LAX) and Claremont station, which is approximately a mile from campus. This option is much more affordable than rideshare, but requires a bus transfer and takes approximately 2 hours. [More information is available here.](#)

8. Can my camper travel alone to camp?



Answer: Unless you are using our unaccompanied minor pickup/dropoff service (described below), your child must be dropped off and picked up on-site by an authorized adult. We are not able to release campers without an authorized adult to sign them out.

Unaccompanied Minor (UM) Airport Service

Our UM airport service allows an NMC representative to meet your child at the gate and bring them to camp (pickup), or bring them to their gate and wait until the flight has departed before leaving (dropoff). In order to utilize this service, your child must be registered as an Unaccompanied Minor with the airline.

Please note that this service has an additional fee beyond any UM fees charged by the airline (see table below), and that availability is limited and on a first-come, first-served basis. **Before booking flights, please email us at info@nationalmathcamps.org to confirm timing and staff availability.**

Camp	Airport	Fee (each way)	Arrival Window	Departure Window
Conway	ONT	\$100	10 am - 3 pm	10:30am - 2:30pm
Conway	LAX*	\$250	10 am - 2 pm	11:30am - 2:30pm
Sierpinski	RDU	\$100	10 am - 3 pm	10:30am - 2:30pm

*For Conway campers utilizing LAX, please note that there may be a long waiting period at the airport before departing for camp as we wait for several flights to arrive. However, campers will be supervised by NMC representatives at all times.

9. Is it possible for me to coordinate with other families on travel logistics? For example, having my child travel with another family who lives nearby or sharing transportation between the airport and camp.

Some families choose to coordinate informally, such as having one parent accompany another's child on a flight or sharing ground transportation to camp. If interested, If interested, you can join the parent's messenger group. For Conway, please join this [link](#), and for Sierpinski, please join this [link](#). Please note that these arrangements are entirely between the families involved; NMC is not responsible for and assumes no liability for privately arranged travel.

Departures



10. What time is pick-up/departure?

Answer: Regular parent pickup time is 8:00 - 10:00 am on departure day. We can accommodate requests for earlier departures with prior notice, but ask you to refrain from any pick-ups prior to 6:00 am.

11. What is the latest time I can pick-up my camper on departure day?

Answer: All campers must check-out by 10:00 am unless other arrangements are approved. Late checkouts will incur a \$30/hour supervision fee.

12. When should I plan on arriving for pick-up?

Answer: Parents can arrive on the morning of pick-up or the day before. There will be a Closing Ceremony at 6:00 pm on the evening before Departure Day, and parents are invited to attend. Please plan to arrive on campus no later than 5:50 pm. Afterwards, we encourage parents to gather for an informal mixer. Location will be announced.

13. Can I pick up my camper early or leave with them directly after the closing ceremony?

Answer: We strongly discourage early dismissals from camp as they are disruptive for the camper and staff. On Friday evening, after the closing ceremony, we have dedicated time for the campers to socialize, reflect on their experiences over the past two weeks, decompress, and say their goodbyes (sign each other's yearbooks, etc.) It is an important rite of passage that your camper will not want to miss out on!

Additionally, we have not built time into the schedule for departure prior to Saturday morning. So an early dismissal would require dedicating a staff person to escort your camper back to the dorm, ensure their room is cleared and all of their belongings packed, clear departure with the health supervisor, and have them ready to meet you for pick-up.

If there are extenuating circumstances that necessitate an early dismissal, we are happy to discuss this with you and accommodate your needs. But, if at all possible, we encourage you to plan travel in alignment with the guidelines previously provided and have your camper depart on Friday morning.

Packing



14. What should my child pack for camp?

Answer: Read the 2026 Camper Packing List.pdf document available for download on the Parent Dashboard in CampSite.

15. Will laundry be available?

Answer: Laundry facilities will not be available unless extenuating circumstances necessitate an exception.

16. What should my child NOT pack for camp?

Answer: Read the Camper Packing List.pdf document available for download on the Parent Dashboard in CampSite.

Bedding

17. Do we need to bring linens?

Answer: For Sierpinski, if you requested the linen package for \$30, William Peace will provide a bath towel, washcloth, hand towel, blanket, fitted sheet, and flat sheet.

For Camp Conway, if you requested the linen package for \$30, Scripps will provide a bath towel, washcloth, hand towel, light blanket, fitted sheet and a flat sheet. Please note that last year, many students found that they needed an additional blanket.

For a complete packing list, refer to the Camper Packing List.pdf available on the Parent Dashboard.

Forms & Permissions

18. What forms do I need to fill out and where can I find them?

Answer: All required forms will be available on CampSite (our camp management platform). Please note that some forms may not be visible just yet, as we are still in the process of finalizing and releasing all materials. Look for the "forms" tab on your parent dashboard. Some of the forms/permissions needed include: medical information (immunization record, allergy and prescription medication requirements, insurance details, etc.), release forms, and emergency



contact info. Please check the dashboard to see all of the forms and note that everything is due to be submitted no later than May 10th to ensure your camper is cleared for participation.

Communications

19. How can I keep in touch with my camper?

Answer: Campers will not have access to mobile devices during most of the camp day. We will provide access during specified periods in the morning (7:00 - 7:30 am) and evening (8:15 - 8:45 pm) for campers to call or text home.

Additionally, parents and authorized family members will have access to the Camp Today platform, our daily blog and photo posting site where they can learn about what is happening in camp that day and view photos of camp activities. The Camp Today platform has a photo recognition feature, and if parents opt-in they can be notified anytime a photo of their child is posted. Parents can also use the platform to send messages directly to their camper.

20. What if I need to reach my camper in an emergency?

Answer: The camp will have a phone line monitored 24/7 in case there is an emergency situation that requires contact with camp leadership or the camper. You will be provided the number before camp begins and it can also be located on CampSite.

21. How do I know my camper is safe?

Answer: The safety and security of our campers is our top priority. We have comprehensive safety policies in place to protect campers and to respond appropriately to any incidents. We are happy to address any particular concerns you have and provide more specific details; please call or email us with questions.

22. Are staff required to do background checks?

Answer: Yes, all counselors, staff, and volunteers at National Math Camps must pass a comprehensive background check and complete training before participating in camp activities.

Dining

23. My child has food allergies, is the cafeteria able to accommodate?



Answer: Our dining hall partners can accommodate most allergies and special diet needs. Please include details on the intake form and we will reach out if there are any issues with accommodations.

24. My child follows a special diet (vegetarian/kosher/halal, etc.) is the cafeteria able to accommodate?

Answer: Our dining hall partners can accommodate most allergies and special diet needs. Please include details on the intake form and we will reach out if there are any issues with accommodations.

Recreation

25. My child plays an instrument. Will there be time to practice and/or a piano available to practice?

Answer: We understand that some students require time to practice. Pianos and space to practice an instrument are available at all of our camps but we cannot guarantee exclusive access to rehearsal rooms. Note that this is an immersive math experience and the campers will be expected to attend all classroom and group activity sessions. If there are specific and or extensive requirements related to their practice please contact us directly to discuss.

26. My child likes to play games on their computer. Can they bring a laptop/tablet to camp or a video game device?

Answer: Conway and Sierpinski are device-free camps and portable game devices and computers are not allowed. There will be ample opportunities to engage in games and entertainment as part of the educational and social programming at the camp. Please refer to NMC 2026_Technology Use Policy.pdf on the Parent Dashboard for full details on our technology use philosophy and policy.

27. My child likes to participate in sports. Will they be able to be active at camp and can I send sporting equipment with them?

Answer: There will be opportunities for your child to stay active and engage in sports with other campers. However, we are unable to guarantee specific times or types of activities, and campers are not permitted to use campus weight or workout equipment.

We will have sports equipment available on site for general use when appropriate. If your child would like to bring their own equipment for a specific sport, they are welcome to do so, but



please note that we cannot guarantee space or time for individual practice, and we are not responsible for lost or damaged items.

Housing

28. What are the dorms like? Private bathrooms or communal? Can they pick roommates? How are roommates assigned?

Answer:

Camp Conway has a mix of single and double rooms. Each counselor group has their own hall with a communal bathroom.

Camp Sierpinski has double rooms with each pair of rooms sharing a dedicated bathroom. Multiple same-gender counselor groups may share a hall.

We ask about rooming preferences in the Parent Questionnaire on Campsite, and will do our best to honor all preferences. This includes preferences for a single vs double (Conway only) as well as specific roommate requests. Roommate requests must be same-gender and mutual. For campers without specific roommate requests, we do our best to assign compatible roommates based on the information in the Parent Questionnaire.

Health

29. My child takes medication. How do you handle that at camp? Can I send my camper with Tylenol or other OTC medications?

Answer: All camper medications should be noted on the medical forms that are filled out on CampSite. Please note that all medications are required to be submitted to the health supervisor during check-in. They will be distributed per prescription or parent-instructed requirements. Limited OTC medications will be available from specific camp staff. You will be able to note on the medical forms which, if any, OTC medications you would not like provided to your child.

30. How do you handle a sick camper?

Answer: If a camper becomes ill, we work closely with the camp health supervisor and the camper's parents or guardians to determine the most appropriate course of action, always



aiming to support the camper in continuing their camp experience if it is safe and reasonable to do so.

Depending on the situation, solutions may include the use of masks, temporary isolation in the camper's room, or moving them to a single room to prevent the spread of illness. If a camper experiences acute symptoms or needs immediate medical attention, we promptly escalate care to a nearby health facility and notify the family right away. Our goal is to respond with care, clarity, and timely communication to ensure the well-being of every camper.

31. This is my child's first time away from home. How are you helping those students so they are not homesick?

Answer: We understand that for many of our campers, this may be their very first time away from home, and that can feel both exciting and a little overwhelming. That's why Camp Conway and Camp Sierpinski each have a dedicated Camper Support Director (CSD) on staff. Our CSD is highly experienced in working with middle school students and is focused on supporting their social and emotional well-being throughout the camp experience. In particular, our CSD staff have backgrounds working with gifted and twice-exceptional (2E) students, and understand the unique ways these campers may experience homesickness or anxiety in new environments. From the very first day, we build a caring, inclusive, and joyful community that helps campers feel safe, seen, and connected. We use daily check-ins, structured peer bonding activities, and responsive one-on-one support to ensure that each camper has the tools and encouragement they need to feel at home at camp.

